

VIII. LAMASSUTUM (154-164)

Elamma's wife Lamassutum – also written Lamassatum, without vowel harmony – is well attested in the archive, both during and after her husband's lifetime and she also occurs in some texts found in other archives. Kt 94/k 543:4-5 mentions: "1 mina 10 shekels of silver / under my seals to Lamassutum / the wife of Elamma; 3 shekels of silver / a consignment for the same woman" (*šēbultam aššiātima*), entrusted somewhere in Anatolia to Ellil-bāni, presumably for delivery in Kanesh. There are several references to her as sender of small amounts of silver to Assur, especially to her daughter Ummī-Išhara (see Ch. II, B). She also figures as writer and as addressee of some letters exchanged with relatives and we meet her in contracts, because she conducted some business of her own, both before and after her husband's death.

A few records of Lamassutum were found among the texts of what must be Ir'am-Aššur's archive (see Ch. XI, introduction). They are a debt-note for $\frac{2}{3}$ mina of silver, which a certain Dadiya owes her (dated only by a double week eponym; Kt 94/k 120), a contract with Iddin-Aššur about the conditional sale of his daughter Ab-šalim (or a loan with his daughter as pledge, dated to eponymy year 100; Kt 94/k 127), and a damaged agreement between her and Ilī-bāni on a sum of silver (Kt 94/k 123). The archival context of these records and the documented family relations suggests her identity with Elamma's wife. Lamassutum also figures anonymously as "the wife of Elamma", e.g. in Kt 93/k 73:11 (see *Appendix* text 23f).¹ In other cases the identification is uncertain, because Lamassutum, "guardian angel", was a popular name for girls. According to Michel (2008, 60f. with note 32) also a sister of Elamma's father had this name and she or a namesake must have written the letters CCT 4, 40a, KUG 39 and Prag I 467 from Assur to Pūšu-kēn and Imdīlum. She also may have been the one who received the small shipments of silver recorded in CCT 6, 27b:9 and TC 3, 207:26. And if she was identical with Elamma's aunt she was different from Lamassutum, daughter of *E-ra-dī* (Prag I 569:8). The identity of the Lamassutum attested in *EL* 180, AKT 1,1:3 (during eponymy year 88) and AKT 6, 12:4', and of the one mentioned in AKT 4, 45:6 and 20 (probably the sister of Ušur-ša-Ištar) has to be established by more prosopographical research.

A. Records on slaves

Three records deal with the sale of the slave-girl Kukra. *154 is an agreement between her and Šamaš-abī, that he will pay her within ten weeks the rest of the price for Kukra; if not the slave-girl becomes her property. *155, designated as "tablet concerning Kukra of the son of Zuzānum" (=Šamaš-abī), records a testimony given under oath by four witnesses at the behest of the Durhumit colony, but since the envelope was not opened we do not know what they testified on. *156 is a deposition by the same four witnesses, also summoned by *kārum* Durhumit, in which they declare that the slave-girl "of Šamaš-abī, son of Zuzānum" had been bought by Šallim-Aššur, son of Iphurum. This tablet could be a copy of the tablet inside the unopened envelope *155, but its implications are not certain, because damage of the bottom of the tablet deprives us of five or six lines of text and the envelope has not been opened.

¹ Comparable to Kt 94/k 543, mentioned above.

154. Kt 91/k 374 (1-231-91)

	20 <i>ma-na</i> URUDU SIG ₅	20 minas of refined copper
	<i>i-ší-im</i> <i>Ku-uk-ra</i>	that remained from the
	<i>i-ri-ih-ma</i>	price for Kukra
	<i>i-še-er</i> ^d UTU- <i>a-bi</i>	is owed by Šamaš-abī
5	<i>Lá-ma-sà-tum tí-šu</i>	to Lamassutum.
	<i>iš-tù</i> <i>ha-mu-uš-tim</i>	From the week eponymy
	<i>ša</i> <i>E-na-ah-DINGIR</i>	of Enah-ilī
9	<i>a-na</i> 10 <i>ha-am-ša-tim</i>	within 10 weeks
l.e.	<i>i-ša-qal</i> <i>šu-ma</i>	he will pay. If he
rev.	<i>lá</i> <i>iš-qú-ul</i>	does not pay
	<i>Ku-uk-ra</i> <i>am-tum</i>	the slave-girl Kukra is
	<i>am-tí</i> : ITU.KAM <i>té-i-na-tim</i>	my slave-girl. Month X,
	<i>li-mu-um</i>	year eponymy of
	<i>Šu-Sú-in</i> DUMU <i>Ba-bi₄-lim</i>	Šu-Suen, son of Babbilum.
15	IGI <i>A-šur-ni-im-ri</i>	Witnessed by Aššur-nimrī,
	IGI <i>Be-lá-nim</i>	by Bēlānum,
	IGI <i>A-mur-A-šur</i>	by Amur-Aššur.

Notes

12-13. A literal quotation of what Lamassutum claimed, if her debtor did not pay in time; cf. *157:20-23.

155. Kt 91/k 391 (1-245-91)

Unopened case provided with the seal impressions of the four persons (the same as those who were witnesses in *156) who testified before the Durhumit colony in the matter of the slave-girl Kukra. It is designated as “tablet concerning Kukra of the son of Zuzānum”.

1	KIŠIB <i>Lá-ba-na-da</i> DUMU [<i>l-d</i>] <i>í-Sú-in</i> Seal of Labān-nādā, son of Iddin-Suen, seal A (upside down)	
	KIŠIB <i>Na-áb-Sú-en₆</i> DUMU <i>Šu-Be-lim</i> seal of Nabi-Suen, son of Šu-Bēlum.	
	KIŠIB <i>l-dí-lštar</i> DUMU <i>l-dí-A-bi₄-im</i> seal of Iddin-lštar, son of Iddin-abum	
	seal B	
	KIŠIB <i>Puzur₄-lštar</i> DUMU <i>Dan-A-šur</i> seal of Puzur-lštar, son of Dān-Aššur.	
l.e.	seal B	
5	<i>a-na</i> <i>a-wa-tim</i>	For these words
rev.	<i>a-ni-a-tim</i> <i>kà-ru-um</i>	the Durhumit colony
	seal C	
	<i>Dur₄-hu-mi-it</i> <i>i-dí-ni-a-tí-ma</i>	made us available and
	IGI GÍR <i>ša</i> <i>A-šur</i>	before Aššur's dagger
	seal D	
	<i>ší-bu-tí-ni</i> : <i>ni-dí-in</i>	we gave our testimony.
u.e.	<i>ṭup-pu-um</i> <i>a-šu-mi</i> <i>Ku-uk-ra</i>	A record concerning Kukra
11	<i>ša</i> °DUMU <i>Zu₂-za-nim</i>	of the son of Zuzānum.

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l.e. seal C
r.e seal D

Seals

seal A : CS 960 = *289 seal A, kt g/k 177. This must be the seal of Labān-nādā, son of Iddin-Suen, (cf. ATHE 22:18 and Kt a/k 299:1), also witness in *289:1 and *156:8'; in this last texts his name is spelled *Lá-ba-lá-da*.

seal B : CS 1159

seal C : CS 1160

seal D: CS 445 = Kt n/k 1763B, 1987, and 1988. According to Ayse Karaduman the inscription on the first envelope shows that it is the seal of Puzur-Ištar, son of Šu-Aššur, but the name of his father must be a mistake for Dān-Aššur, as our text and *156 rev.:15' show; the patronym is also attested in AKT 1, 68A:2-3.

Notes

1-4. The same four witnesses are recorded at the end of *156.

5. The translation "for these words", instead of "for this affair", follows *OALP* 190f.

11. As *156:2 shows, Šamaš-abī, the debtor, is the son of Zuzānum. One of the bullae found in Elamma's archive, *367, with an impression of CS 178 (Özgüç-Tunca 2001, p. 225 and 340, pls. 30, 108, 157), bears the inscription [KIŠIB? A-šur²]-i-dī DUMU Zu-za-ni[m].

156. Kt 91/k 410 (1-263-91)

A testimony by four persons (the same as those who sealed *155), who confirm, at the behest of *kārum* Durhumit, that Šallim-Aššur had bought the slave-girl Kukra. The text was edited in Veenhof 2003b as no. 3

	<i>am-tám : Ku-uk-ra</i>	The slave-girl Kukra,
	<i>ša ^dUTU-a-bi DUMU Zu-za-nim</i>	which Šamaš-abī, son of Zuzānum,
	<i>[iš-tí šu-ha-ri-im</i>	<had acquired?> from the servant
	<i>ša Ha-da-i-kur</i>	of Hada'ikur
	<i>a-lá-hi-nim</i>	the <i>alahhinnu</i> , [?]
5	<i>Ša-lim-A-šur</i>	Šallim-Aššur, son of
	<i>DUMU I_p-hu-ri-im</i>	Iphurum, has bought.
	<i>iš-a-am ha-ma-am</i>	He cut off the
	<i>ma-ah-ri-ni</i>	stalk
	<i>īb-t₂-ū-uq</i>	in our presence.
	(end obv, lo.e. and beginning of rev., ca 5-6 lines, missing)	
rev.	<i>[a-na a]-wa-[tim]</i>	For these
	<i>[a-ni]-a-tim</i>	words the
	<i>kà-ru-um Dur₄-hu-m[i-iš]</i>	Durhumit colony
	<i>i-dī-ni-a-tí-ma</i>	gave us and
5'	<i>IGI GÍR ša A-šur</i>	before Aššur's dagger
	<i><<ša A-šur>> šī-bu-tí-ni</i>	we gave
	<i>ni-dī-in</i>	our testimony.
	<i>IGI Lá-ba-lá-da</i>	In the presence of Labān-nādā,
	<i>DUMU I-dī-Sú-en₆</i>	son of Iddin-Suen,

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10'	IGI <i>Na-áb-Sú-en</i> ₆	of Nabi-Suen,
	DUMU <i>Šu-Be-lim</i>	son of Šu-Bēlum,
u.e.	IGI <i>I-dī-lštar</i>	of Iddin-lštar,
	DUMU <i>I-dī-A-bi</i> ₄ -im	son of Iddin-abum,
le.e.	IGI <i>Puzur</i> ₄ -lštar	of Puzur-lštar,
	DUMU <i>Dan-A-šur</i>	son of Dān-Aššur.

Notes

2b. The words *išti šuhārim* are added in smaller script between the lines. They can only refer to the person “from” whom the girl originally was obtained (see Kienast 1984, 40, § 50 for the use of *išti*), but the formulation “from the servant/boy of H., the *alahhinnum*” (with the unusual *šuhārim ša*), without a verb, is strange. The personal name *Ha-da-i-kur* is unique. I now consider the interpretation as “the slave-girl K., belonging to Š, from the servant of H. Š. has bought”, proposed by me in 2003, less likely than the translation given above, which implies that Šamaš-abī had (again) sold the slave, which interfered with Lamassutum’s claim on her.

5-6. Šallim-Aššur DUMU *[p-hu-]ri-im*, occurs in Kt 91/k 131:1 as witness in a record dated to the year REL 110, and in ATHE 55:8, dated to eponymy year 98.

7-9. The meaning of “cutting the stalk”, symbolizing the sale, was discussed in Veenhof 2003b, in the comments on text 3. It is interesting to note that witnesses who have to confirm that the transaction was completed mention this symbolic action (which is never recorded in any existing deed of sale!), because it may have stuck better in their memory than the sale as such.

8’. The spelling of the name with doubled */nn/* rendered by */(l)/* is curious. The same man figures in ATHE 22:18, also as witness, in a case before the Durhumit colony.

Comment

A reconstruction of the affair is difficult, also because the two depositions are undated. I assume that Šamaš-abi, son of Zuzānum (who occurs in Kt 93/k 9:13-14 - courtesy of C. Michel - as a transporter and as witness in AKT 6, 838:5, undated) had bought the slave-girl (the seller may be mentioned in *156:2-4, see below) with money advanced by Lamassutum, part of which - 20 minas of refined copper, equivalent to ca. 20 shekels of silver - he failed to pay back. Later he may have sold the slave-girl to Šallim-Aššur, apparently without having paid back Lamassutum. She then must have summoned him and her claim may have led to a lawsuit before the colony, in the course of which *155, a deposition by the four witnesses, played a role. In *156 they confirm that the slave-girl really had been sold (again) by Šamaš-abī, but we do not know how the case ended. It is difficult to consider the agreement *154 the result of the intervention by the colony, because it is not presented as its verdict or as a solution by mediators or persons “who solved the case” (*pāšir awātim*). Moreover, if the slave-girl had been sold to a new owner Lamassutum could not stipulate that the girl would become her property if her new owner defaulted, unless this sale was contested, because the seller could not sell his encumbered property. The *kārum* may have decided that the sale by Šamaš-abī was not valid, because he still owed part of the price of the girl to Lamassutum, but such a verdict is missing. It is more likely that *154 documents an early phase of the transaction, which established Šamaš-abī’s debt and stipulated what would happen if he failed to pay in time. One could then assume that the defaulting Šamaš-abī, instead of handing over the slave-girl to Lamassutum, had sold her, perhaps even in order to use the price paid for her to pay Lamassutum. That the debt-note *154 was found in Lamassutum’s archive does not contradict this,

because the tablet may have been preserved after its sealed envelope had been broken.

157. Kt 91/k 286 (1-143-91)

This unopened envelope, sealed by two cylinder seals and four different stamp seals, records the sale of a slave-girl by an Anatolian couple to Lamassutum in the presence of only Anatolian witnesses. The record includes various clauses protecting the buyer against actions of the sellers and third persons.

	KIŠIB <i>Du-šu-ba</i> KIŠIB <i>Šu-ni-il₅-ga</i>	Seal of Dušuba, seal of Šunilga,
	KIŠIB <i>Ší-li-ú-ma-an</i>	seal of Šuliuman,
	KIŠIB <i>Tal-ha-ma</i>	seal of Talhama,
	2x stamp seal A	
	KIŠIB <i>Šar-bu-nu-a</i> KIŠIB <i>Kà-áš-ší</i>	seal of Šarbunuwa, seal of Kašši,
	cylinder seal B	
l.e.	KIŠIB <i>Gà-dí-na : am-tám</i>	seal of Gadina. The slave-girl
6	<i>Ku-zi-zi</i>	Kuzizi
	stamp seal C, 3x	
	<i>Du-šu-ba ú Šu-ni-il₅-ga</i>	Dušuba and Šunilga
rev.	<i>a-ší-mi-im i-dí-nu-ma</i>	sold her and
	15 GÍN KÙ.B.	15 shekels of silver
	cylinder seal D	
10	<i>Lá-ma-sú-tum ta-áš-qú-ul-ma</i>	Lamassutum paid and
	<i>am-tám Ku-zi-zi ta-áš-am</i>	bought the slave-girl Kuzizi.
	<i>šu-ma um-ma Du-šu-ba-ma</i>	If Dušuba and Šunilga say:
	<i>ù Šu-ni-il₅-ga-ma a-ma-at-ni</i>	"We want to take our slave-girl along",
	<i>ni-ta-ru ½ ma-na KÙ.B.</i>	they will pay ½ mina of silver and
15	<i>i-ša-qú-lu-ma am-tám i-ta-ru</i>	then they can take the slave-girl along.
	<i>šu-ma ma-ma-an i-tù-ra-/am</i>	If anybody vindicates her, saying:
	<i>um-ma šu-ut-ma am-tum</i>	"The slave-girl is mine!"
	<i>i-a-tum Du-šu-ba</i>	then I have a claim on Dušuba
	<i>ú Šu-ni-il₅-ga ú É-sú-nu</i>	and Šunilga and their house.
20	<i>a-da-ga-al : šu-ma KÙ.B.-pi</i>	Should they not give me
u.e.	<i>lá i-ta-ad-nu-nim</i>	my silver then
	stamp seal E	
le.e.	<i>am-tum Ku-zi-zi am-tí</i>	the slave-girl Kuzizi is my slave-girl
	cylinder seal D	
	<i>ù a-ší-mi-im a-da-ší</i>	and I can sell her.

Seals

seal A: St. 139

seal B: CS

seal C: St

seal D: CS 1145 = *296D, the seal of Šar(a)bunuwa.

Notes

6. The sellers must be an Anatolian couple (Šunilga is a female name and their house serves as security, l. 18). Another(?) Dušuba figures in Kt v/k 161:7 (courtesy Donbaz)

together with Halušta, as debtor, for a substantial amount of silver due to the Assyrian Ennam-Aššur during the year REL 104.

12-13. Note the irregular repetition of *-ma* after the name of both sellers, not used in I. 7.

17. One would have expected *jāt*, as predicate of a nominal sentence, as used in KTS 7a:25, *i-a-at*, “she is mine!”.

Comment

The description of the girl sold as “the slave-girl Kuzizi” indicates that the Anatolians did not sell their daughter into slavery, but a slave-girl they already owned, presumably to meet a debt-claim. Nevertheless, the sellers retain the possibility of buying her back, which they can do by declaring “We take her along”, using the verb *tarā’um* that is typical for such situations (see Kienast 1984, 74ff., on the “Retraktklauseln”, in the combination *šaqālum + tarā’um*). They can get her back by paying twice the sale price, which makes it difficult (since they presumably are already in debts) to make use of their right (see Veenhof, *Studies Matouš* II, 295ff. and R. Westbrook, *Property and the Family in Biblical Law*, Sheffield 1991, Ch. 5, on the “price factor” in redemption). Lines 19-21 consider the possibility that the sellers (try to) take the girl along without paying and state that she then becomes the full property of the buyer, as a chattel slave. Cuneiform law does not have an abstract definition of “ownership”, but stating, as in our contract, the right to sell what has been bought (which implies that redemption is then excluded) is its nearest approach. Cf. in Old Babylonian CT 4, 7a, a dispute about the ownership of a house acquired by exchange, where one party declares (lines 25-32), “He gave me the full price of my house and a house in exchange for a house, so that I am satisfied. I can give it where I wish. What claim do you have on me?” In our contract the possibility of selling the girl may not only have been an expression of full ownership, but have been intended by Lamassutum, if the slave-girl was merely sold to cover a debt and she wished to see money.

Protection against vindication by a third party is provided by stipulating that the buyer in that case will make the sellers with their property (their house) liable for it, for which the verb *dagalum*, “to look at, have a claim on, to acquire ownership of” is used (see Veenhof 2001, 129, 3). In this clause, as in the one about attempts by the sellers to recover their property, the buyer is speaking and the writer of the record quoted what Lamassutum said *verbatim*, as happens more often, especially when mentioning specific securities claimed by the buyer (or creditor); (cf. *154:12-13)

B. Debt-notes

158. Kt 92/k 162 (91-122-93)

This undated debt-note (an unopened envelope) records that Aššur-lamassī owes Lamassutum an amount of refined silver, to be paid within four months.

seal A

[KI]ŠIB A-šur-^dUTU^{ši} DUMU Šu-lštar Seal of Aššur-šamšī, son of Šu-lštar,
 [KIŠI]B A-šur-lá-ma-sí seal of Aššur-lamassī,
 [KIŠIB Da]n-A-šur DUMU Ku-sú-sà- seal of Dān-Aššur, son of Kususārum.
 [x] ma-na KÙ ša-ru-pá-am [ri-im [x] mina of refined silver
 seal B

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5	<i>i-še-er A-šur-lá-ma-/sí</i>	Aššur-lamassī
l.e.	seal C	
	<i>L[a m]a-sà-[tu]m tí-šu</i>	owes to Lamassutum.
rev.	seal C	
	<i>iš-tù ha-mu-uš-tim</i>	From the week of
	<i>[š]a Kur-ub-lštar ù</i>	Kurub-lštar and
	<i>l-lí-iš-ta-kál a-na</i>	lliš-tikal he will pay
10	<i>°4 ITI.KAM i-ša-qal šu-ma</i>	in 4 months. If he does not
	<i>lá iš-qúl ki-ma a-wa-at</i>	pay, he will add interest
	<i>kà-ri-im ší-ib-tám</i>	in accordance with the regulation
	seal A	
	<i>ú-ša-áb</i>	of the colony.
u.e.	seal C	
le.e.	seal B	

Seals

seal A = CS 1233, must be the seal of Dān-Aššur, son of Kususārum.

seal B = CS 1161 = *15 C, inscription: *A-šur-lá-ma-sí / DUMU A-lá-hi-im*

seal C = CS 1234, inscription *°A-šur-UTU^š / DUMU Šu- lštar*.

Notes

3. The same man with his patronym is attested in CTMMA 74:15, a letter to Imdī-ilum.

7-9. The same pair of week-eponyms in Kt c/k 1007:9, but also without mention of the eponymy year. Since double week-eponyms disappear after eponymy year 98, this contract must date to the period when Lamassutum, while her husband was perhaps still alive, was already engaged in private business. What this business was remains unclear, because the amount of the debt is missing and debt-notes almost never mention the reason of the debt. Aššur-lamassī occurs many times in records of the archive (see also *Appendix*, text 10, from year REL 88) as witness, as transporter of silver and textiles, and involved in his own, modest transactions (*129:3, 12 *kutānū*; *68:18, 11 *kutānū*). Here he may have contracted a (small) loan or have taken some merchandise, probably textiles, in commission from Lamassutum.

159. Kt 91/k 388 (1-242-91)

An unopened envelope with a unique contract from eponymy year REL 95, in which a man obliges himself to provide Lamassutum within two months with wool fit for the weft, on penalty of delivering double that quantity.

	seal A (upside down)	
	KIŠIB <i>A-šur-dan</i> DUMU <i>l-ku-pi-a</i>	Seal of Aššur-dān, son of Ikuppiya,
	KIŠIB <i>l-dí-A-bi₄-im</i>	seal of Iddin-abum,
	DUMU <i>l-tur₄-DINGIR</i>	son of Itūr-ilī,
	KIŠIB <i>A-šur-ták-lá-ku</i> DUMU <i>Hu-/li-a</i>	seal of Aššur-taklāku, son of Huliya.
5	<i>30 <ma-na> SÍG.HI.A na-ar-ba-tim</i>	30 <minas> of soft,
	<i>°x x x x₂*- tim</i>	 wool
l.e.	seal B	
rev.	<i>ša-kà-ki-iš</i>	for making the weft
	<i>i-še-er</i>	Aššur-taklāku, son of

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10	A-šur-ták-lá-ku DUMU Hu-li-a [L]á-ma-sà-tum tí-šu iš-tù Ha-qá a-na ITU.2.KAM ù-šé-ba-lam šu-ma lá ú-uš-té-bi₄-lam-/ma seal C <a>[?]É_j* A-lim^{ki} i-ta-lá-/ak seal A	Huliya, owes to Lamassutum. He will send it from Haqa within two months. If he has not sent it and has departed for² the City Hall
15	i-na tù-wa-ri-šu l.e. 1 GÚ SÍG.HI.A na-ar-b[a]-/tim ša-kà-ki-iš i-ša-/qal ITU.1.KAM ku-zal-lu li-mu-um A-šur-na-da DUMU Puzur₄-/A-na	he will weigh out on his return one talent of soft wool for making the weft. Month XI, eponymy of Aššur-nādā, son of Puzur-Anna

Seals

seal A: CS 1150, inscription: ^dNIN.ŠUBUR / SUKKAL.ZI AN.NA / GIDRI[?] KÙ.ŠU.DU₇ / x[?]
^dEN.ZU- ma-g^r-[ir²] (I am grateful to T.J.H. Krispijn for help in reading the
 inscription). Several OB seals with an invocation of Ninšubur, the vizier of Inanna, are
 known, see D. Collon, *Catalogue of Western Asiatic Seals in the British Museum,*
Cylinder Seals III (London 1986), index p. 237, often writing SUKKAL AN.NA or
 SUKKAL ^dINANNA, but ZI.AN.NA on no. 394. Some add to it, as on our seal,
 gišGIDRI KÙ.ŠU.DU₇ (“holding a pure staff”), *ibidem* nos. 52, 191 and 242; also Tell
 Sifr 62a, seal 9 – see D. Charpin, *Archives familiales* ... [1980], 248 - and L.
 Speleers, *Catalogue...* [1917], p. 177 no. 701). See also Th. Richter,
Untersuchungen zu den lokalen Panthea Süd- und Mittelbabyloniens in
altbabylonischer Zeit (AOAT 257, Münster 1999), p. 322 note 1293. In none of these
 examples the personal name of the owner of the seal is added to the invocation, as
 is the case in our text. The new OA owner, who cannot be identified, used it without
 adapting its inscription.

seal B: CS 1151

seal C: CS 1123 = Kt 91/k 236, seal A, on a fragment of an envelope, without any
 name preserved.

Notes

4, 8. The debtor is unknown from other texts and he might be the user of seal A, which
 has an unfamiliar and difficult inscription, which starts with mentioning a deity, while the
 personal name of line 4 seems to be Babylonian (Old Assyrian has no names with
māgir as predicate).

6. The first two signs are obliterated by the seal impression; the final *-tim* suggests a
 further qualification of the wool, but the traces exclude those used in TC 3, 65:18-22,
šaptam naribtam araktam damiqtam ūtartam, and also *lahhutum*, *makrītum*, *šinītum*
 and *ūšītum* (see for them Michel-Veenhof 2010, 215, and Lassen 2010, 160) are
 impossible.

7. The verb *šakākum*, better known as “to string, thread” (a cord, rope or beads) and
 “to harrow”, is apparently used here in a specific meaning, whereby the movement of the
 shuttle, to apply the weft, is comparable to that of a harrow on a field. The use of an
 infinitive with the terminative ending *-iš* instead of *ana*, is rare in OA, but attested, cf.
muātiš alākum, “come close to dying” (see *Grammar* § 19.23).

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11. A Haqa was a station on the road located in the mountainous region east of the Euphrates, from where at least two roads went in western direction, to Zalpa and Tegarama

12, 13. The spelling *ú-uš-* is very unusual. At the beginning of 13 the traces exclude *a-na* and suggest tentatively emended to <a>-É, since *alākum* + accusative is very uncommon. My reading, if correct, gives a hint of Aššur-taklāku's position.

Comment

Lamassutum must have been producing textiles in Kanesh, presumably woolen *pirikannū*-textiles, perhaps with the aid of her slave-girls (*164:23 mentions five of them), when her husband was still alive. Lassen 2010, 165, mentions a few other texts in which Lamassutum is involved with wool, but I am not certain that it is always the same woman, because the name was rather common in Old Assyrian. Lamassutum in our contract needs soft wool for making the weft. To obtain this type of wool she contracts (and presumably provides money to) Aššur-taklāku, who has to send it from Haqa, situated north of Zalpa, on the road from Assur to Tegarama (*Geography* 111). It may have been available there thanks to imports from the north, from Luhusaddiya or the region around modern Çorum, a centre of wool production and trade (see Lassen 2010, 168f.). Aššur-taklāku may have passed Haqa on his trip to Assur, and if he fails to carry out his commission and travels straight to Assur, he has to supply double the quantity contracted as a penalty. That the debt-note was preserved unopened in Elamma's archive might indicate that the commission was not carried out.

160. Kt 91/k 376 (1-233-91)

An undated contract recording that Lamassatum supplied Amriya with a small working capital that obliged him to be at her service.

	[i-še-er ²] be-ú-lá-tí-/šu	[In addition to] his [previous?]
	[pá-ni-ŋim	working capital,
	[ša] Lá-ma-ša	[which] Lamaša
	[a]-na Am-ri-a	had given to
5	i-dí-nu a-ha-ma	Amriya, separately
	10 GÍN KÙ.B	Lamassutum
	La-ma-sú-tum	gave 10 shekels
	a-na Am-ri-a	of silver
9	a-be-a-lim	to Amriya
l.e.	ta-dí-in	to dispose of.
	Am-ri-a	Amriya
	iš-tí KÙ.B	is being held
	uk-ta-al	with the silver.
	[šu]-ma a-e-ma	If he goes away
15	[ú]-da-pi-ir	somewhere else
	[x x GÍ]N ² ú-ma-lá	he shall compensate [x] shekels.
	[IGI x x]-A-šūr	In the presence of [.....]-Aššur,
	[IGI x x]- ^d IM	of [.....]-Adad.

Notes

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1-2. The restoration conjectural and instead of *išṣēr* also *ellān* is possible.

3-4. Lamaša is a man, although the name is also given to women (e.g. the wife of Buzāzu). Amriya does not occur in other texts from the archive; we know nothing of his service as “harnesser” and we cannot identify him because no filiation is given.

14-16. *Be’ulātu*-contracts stipulate a variety of penalties for abandoning the service, see Veenhof 1994. They range from paying back the loan received (e.g. ICK 2, 107) or interest on it (ICK 1, 83; *67), to paying or compensating (*mallu’um*) the cost of hiring a substitute and paying a fine as penalty. Prag I 456 and KKS 9 stipulate the payment of the equivalent of the amount of silver received “on top of” (*ana ṣēr*) the working capital received, which amounts to a 100% fine. Kt n/k 1807 speaks simply of “he shall pay 1 mina of silver”; AKT 1, 9:9-13, “if he does not pack our goods he will pay 1 mina of silver” (for the 33⅓ shekels received). The use of *mallu’um* is standard when the harnesser has to compensate the wages of a substitute hired by his employer, but our contract does not mention a substitute and refers only to the silver he has to pay as penalty; damage of the tablet hides how big the penalty in this case was.

Comment

That somebody already in the possession of a *be’ulātu*-loan, which bound him to his creditor, accepted a second loan of that kind is curious, but even though my restoration of *išṣēr* in line 1 is conjectural, the use of *ahamma* in l. 5 supports this interpretation. The liability assumed by such a loan usually ended by returning the silver received, which presumably implied that the contract was cancelled. Here the contract of the earlier loan is said to be still in existence and therefore the debt had not been paid back, so that Amriya apparently received an small additional sum of silver (10 shekels; a *be’ulātu*-loan usually was bigger, 25 or 30 shekels). How the obligations towards his two creditors, created by these two loans, were met remains unclear.

161. Kt 91/k 515 (1-368-91)

This debt-note, of which the damaged envelope (A) and the complete tablet inside it (B) are preserved, records a modest claim in silver by Lamassutum on three Anatolians (two of them are a couple), dated to eponymy year REL 106 and protected by a double security clause.

A. Envelope

	KIŠIB Ša-ar-ni-ga-a-šu	Seal of Šarnigāšu,
	seal A	
	KIŠIB E-na-A-šur DU°MU x x ₂	seal of Ennam-Aššur, son of [.....],
	KIŠIB Wa-al-hi-[iṣ-na]	seal of Walhišna,
	KIŠIB Pé-ru-wa KIŠIB Tù-wa-tù-ú-ī	seal of Peruwa, se[al of Tuwatuwi].
	seal B	
l.e.	missing	
rev.	missing	
u.e.	seal C	
l.e.e.	šu-ma KÙ.B. i-ša-x []	If [they] pay the silver
	seal D (damaged)	
r.e.	seal E (damaged)	

Seals

seal A: CS 1224

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seal B: CS 1225

seal C: St

B. Tablet

	15 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>li-tí</i>	15 shekels of refined
	SIG ₅ <i>i-še-er</i>	<i>liti</i> -silver
	<i>Wa-al-hi-iš-na</i>	Walhišna,
	<i>Pé-ru-wa ù Tù-wa-tù-ú-i</i>	Peruwa and Tuwatuwi,
5	<i>a-ší-tí-šu Lá-ma-sà-tum</i>	his wife, owe to
	<i>tí-šu iš-tù</i>	Lamassutum. From
	<i>ha-mu-uš-tim</i>	the week of
	<i>ša l-na-a</i>	Innāya
	<i>a-na ša Pá-ar-kà</i>	not later than the festival of Parka
10	<i>i-ša-qú-lu</i>	they will pay.
l.e.	<i>šu-ma lá iš-qú-lu</i>	If they do not pay
	1½ GÍN.TA	they will add interest
rev.	<i>ší-ib-tám</i>	at a rate of 1½ shekel.
	<i>ú-šú-bu ITI.KAM</i>	Month
15	<i>a-lá-na-tim</i>	XII,
	<i>li-mu-um</i>	eponymy of
	<i>A-šur-i-mi-tí KÙ.B.</i>	Aššur-imitti. They are
	<i>i-qá-qá-<ad> šál-mi-šu-nu</i>	jointly liable for
	<i>ra-ki-is šu-ma <i-na> u₄-me-šu-/nu</i>	the silver. Should they not pay
20	<i>lá iš-ta-aq-lu</i>	when their term is due,
	<i>Tù-wa-tù-wi</i>	then I will take Tuwatuwi.
	<i>ú-šé-ša</i> (erasure)	away (from the house).
u.e.	IGI <i>Ša-ar-ni-/ga-a-šu</i>	In the presence of Šarnigāšu,
le.e.	IGI <i>E-na-A-šur</i>	and of Ennam-Aššur.

Notes

B:2, 4. The name of the father of the second witness is very damaged, but it is not Elamma (in which case he would be a son of Lamassutum). The last seal must have been that of Tuwatuwi.

B: le.e. The words are enigmatic and do not match the text on the tablet. The only possibility seems to be a clause stipulating that they can get the wife, handed over as security, back when they pay.

B:12. The stipulation on the rate of interest is incomplete. Understanding it as “1½ shekel <per mina per month>”, i.e. the normal default interest of 30% per year, as in *162, seems much more likely than “1 ½ shekel <per month>”, which would mean an extremely high rate of more than 100% per year.

A:17. The year eponym must be that of year REL 106, elsewhere designated as *malahum*, since the week eponym of Innāya is well attested for that year, also during month XII (Kt a/k 555:6).

A:22. The causative of *wašā'um* usually means “to obtain the release of”, tantamount to “to redeem”, e.g. in WAG 48-1464:19-20 (who claims the slaves shall pay silver and redeem them, *kaspam išaqqal ušešša*), AKT 3, 92:35-36 (“bring the silver and its interest and get the release of your slave-girls”, *amātikunu šēšīā*), and BIN 6,68:27-28 (“you have paid the silver and obtained the release of my pledges”, *šaprātia tušēšīā*). A meaning “to take away” (as pledge) is unusual (this is normally expressed by *tarā'um*

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or *tabālum*, but it occurs in *EL* 252:23, where the offer of lines 11-13, “give me x silver and take my slave and slave-girl along (*taru*)”, results in *amtam ušēši*. It has parallels in Old Babylonian, e.g. Grant, *Business Documents* 57:6, where a man who took out a loan, “made his (the debtor’s) son leave (his house as pledge) for the silver” ([*mārašu*] *ana kaspim ušēši*, written ÍB.TA.AN.Ē).

Comment

Lamassutum grants a small loan or extends credit to two Anatolians, who have rather common names and cannot be identified. The transaction took place at the end of eponymy year 106 and the due date is the festival of Parka, around the time of the summer harvest. The claim is secured by the short clause of joint liability (with omits *u kēnišunu*) and by the provision that, if the debtors do not pay in time, the wife of the second debtor will be taken away as pledge. The use of the perfect *ištaqlu* is very rare in debt-notes and may betray that the scribe was not a professional (note also the mistakes in lines 18 and 19). *Ušešša*, a first person singular, is a literal quote of what the creditor said, a feature not rare in security clauses in OA contracts.

162. Kt 92/k 149 (1-109-92)

A contract recording a debt of 13 shekels of silver due by Ilī-bāni, dated to eponymy year REL 106 and payable within 5 weeks, with a stipulation on default interest.

	13 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>ša-ru-pá-am i-še-er</i> <i>Ilī₅-ba-ni DUMU A-šur-UTU^{šī}</i> <i>Lá-ma-sà-tum : tí-šu</i>	13 shekels of refined silver Ilī-bāni, son of Aššur-šamšī, owes to Lamassutum.
5	<i>iš-tù : ha-muš-tim</i> <i>ša l-tur₄-DINGIR (erasure)</i> ITI. 1.KAM <i>ša sà-ra-tim</i> <i>li-mu-um ša qá-té</i> <i>A-šur-i-mi-tí ma-lá-hi-/im</i>	Reckoned from the week-eponymy of Itūr-ilī, month II, year-eponymy of the successor of Aššur-imtī, the boatman,
10	<i>a-na 5 ha-am-ša-tim</i> <i>[i-š]a-qal</i>	within 5 weeks he will pay.
l.e.	<i>[šū-m]a lá iš-qúl</i> <i>[a-n]a 1 ma-na-im</i> <i>1½ GÍN.TA <<i-na>></i>	If he does not pay he will add per mina, per month
15	<i>i-na ITI. 1.KAM-im</i> <i>ší-ib-tám ú-ša-áb</i> IGI <i>A-šur-be-el-a-wa-/tim</i> DUMU <i>I-dí-Da-gán</i> IGI <i>A-šur-e-mu-qí</i>	1½ shekel as interest. In the presence of Aššur-bēl-awātim, son of Iddin-Dagan, of Aššur-emūqī,
20	DUMU <i>Ku-zi-zi-a</i>	son of Kuziziya.

Notes

3. The debtor seems to be unknown from other texts, but we have references to an Aššur-šamšī, son of Ilī-bāni. The name of the sun-god in the second name is written without determinative.

17-20. The first witness occurs as debtor in Kt 87/k 270:4-5, 8, dated to month IV of year eponymy REL 105.; the second seems to be unknown from other texts.

C. Other texts

163. Kt 91/k 468 (1-321-91)

A damaged, large envelope of a letter, which was probably addressed to Lamassatum.

seal A	
<i>a-na La-[ma-sà-tim.....]</i>	To La[massutum]
°KIŠIB [.....]	se]al of [.....]
<i>mì-°x] °x me-eh-r₂[i x x]</i>	 the duplicates?
<i>ša [ta]-áš-pu-ri-ni</i>	that you sent
seal A	
(remainder obv. missing)	
rev. seal A	
(3.5 cm un-inscribed)	
seal A	

Seal

seal A: CS 1188

Notes

1. Name of addressee is suggested by the fact that the texts comes from Elamma's archive.

Comment

The letter inside must have measured ca. 7.0 x 5.0 cm, but the traces on the inside of the envelope do not allow its identification.

164. Kt 91/k 421 (1-279-91)

This record about the last will of Lamassutum, dated to month II of REL 107, was edited and commented upon by me in Veenhof 2012a, 196-200 (text 4), to which I refer the reader. The comment given below summarizes the main issues relevant for the business and family history of Elamma. Our text is not the testament, but a memorandum that quotes, after Lamassutum's death, what she said or spoke in the first person singular ("my seals", lines 3 and 5, and also lines 17, 19, 35, 36), to all appearances in her last will that we do not have. The memorandum, also writes about her in the third person singular - "all this Lamassutum, wife of Elamma, left behind", lines 26-28 - may have been drawn up for the use of those, probably her representatives mentioned in lines 28-30, who had to carry out her dispositions, presumably because all the assets mentioned and probably also the original would be sent to Assur (as lines 33-34 state), where the final division of the inheritance would take place. I note that a house in Kanesh does not figure among her assets, perhaps because Elamma's house there had been inherited by Elamma's eldest son, who may have been obliged to let his mother live there (as was the case in *297, discussed in Veenhof 1998, 141-144).

3	<i>kà-sá-tum ù tù-dí-na-/tum</i>	3 cups and toggle pins,
	<i>šu-qú-ul-ta-áš-na</i>	their weight in silver
	1 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ku-nu-ku-a</i>	1 mina, under my seals;
	<i>a-ha-ma 1/3 ma-na 6 GÍN</i> KÙ.B.	separately 25 shekels of silver
5	<i>ku-nu-ku-a-ma ik-ri-bu</i>	also under my seals, <i>ikribū</i> of

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	<i>ša E-lá-ma 2 ṭup-pu-ú</i>	Elamma; 2 tablets of
	<i>ša 2 ma-na 15 GÍN KÙ.B.</i>	2 minas and 15 shekels of silver,
	<i>ša hu-bu-ul nu-a-im 1 ṭup-pu-um</i>	being the debt of the Anatolian; 1 tablet
	<i>ša ½ ma-na KÙ.B. ša hu-bu-ul</i>	of 1½ mina of silver, being
10	<i>Na-ni-a 1 ṭup-pu-um</i>	the debt of Naniya; 1 tablet
	<i>ša 1 ma-na 6 GÍN KÙ.B.</i>	of 1 mina and 6 shekels of silver,
	<i>ša hu-bu-ul Bur-Sú-en₆</i>	being the debt of Būr-Suen;
	<i>1 ṭup-pu-um ša 1/3 ma-na 4 GÍN</i>	1 tablet of 24 shekels of silver
	<i>KÙ.B. ša hu-bu-ul Ili₅-tap-pá</i>	being the debt of Ilī-tappā;
15	<i>1 ma-na KÙ.B. a-na Ir-ma-A-šūr</i>	1 mina of silver, (which) I gave to
l.e.	<i>a-na ší-a-ma-tim</i>	Ir'am-Aššur for making purchases;
	<i>a-dí-in 1 ma-na KÙ.B.</i>	1 mina of silver (which)
rev.	<i>a-na Ah-ša-lim a-na</i>	I gave to Ah-šalim for
	<i>ší-a-ma-tim a-dí-in</i>	making purchases.
20	<i>9 TÚG pí-ri-kà-ni ù 1 TÚG / a-bar-ni-am</i>	9 <i>pirikannu</i> -textiles and 1 Abarnian
one,	<i>a-na Pí-lá-ah-lštar</i>	(which) I gave to Pilah-lštar
	<i>a-na ší-a-ma-tim a-dí-in¹</i>	for making purchases;
	<i>5 ÌR-du ù 5 a-ma-tum</i>	5 slaves and 5 slave-girls,
	<i>ŠÀ.BA 1 am-tum l-a-an-tal-/ga</i>	of which 1 slave-girl, named Iyantalga,
25	<i>ša Ì-lí-na DUMU.SAL A-šur-DUG</i>	is for Ilina, daughter of Aššur-ṭāb.
	<i>mì-ma a-nim Lá-ma-sà-tum</i>	All this, Lamassutum,
	<i>DAM E-lá-ma</i>	the wife of Elamma,
	<i>té-zi-ib : lštar-pá-li-il₅</i>	left behind. lštar-pāilil,
	<i>En-na-Sú-in ù Ma-ší-i-lí</i>	Ennam-Suen and Maši-ilī,
30	<i>ša ki-ma Lá-ma-sà-tim a-na</i>	Lamassutum's representative(s),
	<i>DUMU um-mì-a-nim ù ma-ri-ša</i>	will entrust it to a licensed trader
	<i>i-pá-qí-du-ma a-na</i>	and to her sons and they
u.e.	<i>a-lim^{ki} ú-bu-lu-ú-ma</i>	will bring it to the City and
34	<i>a-ma-lá</i>	(there) my daughter, the <i>ugbabbu</i> -
le .e.	<i>ší-ma-tí-šu-nu me-er-i-tí : NIN.DINGIR</i>	priestess, and my sons will act
	<i>ù ma-ru-ú-a e-pu-š[u]</i>	in accordance with the testamentary
		dispositions applying to them.

Notes

8-18. It is difficult to identify the persons who owed Lamassutum money. The “Anatolian” (l. 8) might be Lullu, the second husband of lštar-lamassī and hence a member of the family. Naniya features as witness in *112:8; Bur-Suen appears as transporter of silver for Elamma in *47:4.26 and *19:11.36, and as his debtor for 55 shekels of silver in *70:13; (an) Ilī-tappā, son of Idnāya, is witness in *312:3. Ir'am-Aššur was married to Lamassutum's daughter Šalimma and there are several references to Ah-šalim, a well-known name, perhaps the son of Buzutaya (*204:11), who also acted as transporter for Elamma (*82:5) and received and owed silver in *117:3 // *310:4 and *90:4.10.18 (accounts settled with him according to *85:15'f.) and some textiles in *317:6.

25. Ilina, daughter of Aššur-ṭāb, occurs only here and may have been a granddaughter or a grand-niece (if this Aššur-ṭāb is the son of Elamma's brother Ali-ahum) of Lamassutum, who had somehow deserved her gratitude.

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28-30. It is not clear whether all three men or (which seems more likely) only the third, Maši-ilī, was Lamassutum's representative. The latter could be the son of Buzuzu (*173:10, *180:18) and must be the man who also figures in the records dealing with the aftermath of Ištar-lamassī's death (*185:6; *177:28). He may have been employed by Elamma, for according to *39:27 he had received a "working capital". We encounter Ištar-pāilil, presumably the son of Šu-Kūbum, as debtor of Ali-ahum, Elamma's brother, in *300:5, 21. There are too many different Ennam-Suen's to identify him, but he may well be the man of that name many of whose records, edited in this volume, were found in Elamma's house (see Ch. XIII).

35. The title of Lamassutum's daughter, NIN.DINGIR, the OA equivalent of *ugbabtum*, is sufficient to identify her without mentioning her name.

Comment

The assets Lamassutum left behind were substantial: silver objects, cash silver and debt claims on various persons amounting to in all 8½ minas of silver, plus ten textiles and ten slaves and slave-girls. The origin of these assets is not mentioned, some may have belonged to her dowry or have been given to her by her husband (e.g. the silver cups and toggle-pins), but since he died several years earlier she may also have obtained some as her share in his inheritance (wives did inherit from their husbands, see Veenhof 2012, 176-7). The temple funds (*ikribū*), put at Elamma's disposal (lines 5-6), may have been passed on to her in this way and possibly also some of the other claims listed in lines 6-14. Other assets were debts owed to herself, resulting from her commercial activities, as documented in the debt-notes published above, and from the fact that she had made amounts of silver available to Assyrians, among them her relative Ir'am-Aššur, "for (to make) purchases" (lines 15-19), probably in Assur. But this expression is also used in I. 22, where sale in Anatolia of textiles "given" to Pilah-Ištar (presumably her son) is meant. The nine *pirikannu*-textiles he received in fact may have been woven by her or her slave-girls, for in *159 she commissioned a trader to buy wool for her. Lamassutum also owned quite a number of slaves, perhaps including some she had bought herself, such as the one recorded in *157.

That her representatives had to entrust "all this" for shipment to Assur may imply that outstanding claims had to be collected and the slaves were sold (apart from one), to send their yield in silver there. But we cannot exclude that eventually some debt-notes were assigned to her sons, to be collected later in Anatolia. That the final accounting and division of the inheritance would take place in Assur – where also Lamassutum's sons had to go for this purpose (lines 31-33) and where Ummī-Išhara lived as priestess – is known from other texts. The final injunction, "My daughter ... and my sons shall act in accordance with the testamentary dispositions applying to them", obviously quoted from her testament, might reflect some fear about the execution of her last will, but it may also have been fairly standard clause. Other testaments show that "executors" (*bēl šīmātim*) would monitor the division.